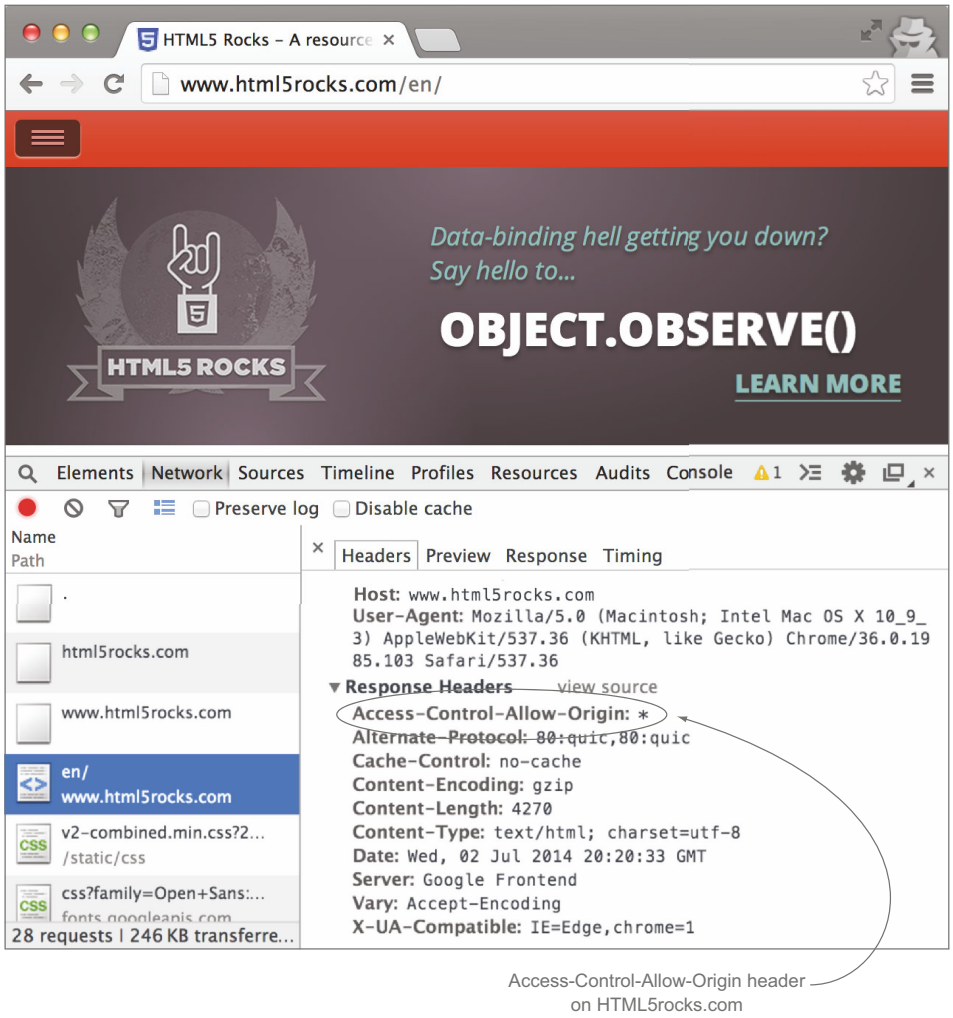


Figure 3.20 html5rocks.com always adds the Access-Control-Allow-Origin: * header to responses.

The wildcard value is ideal for situations where anyone can access the data, regardless of the client. A good example is the HTML5Rocks.com website. The website itself is a public resource, accessible from any browser, without any authentication. If you make a request to HTML5rocks.com and examine the response in the console, you'll see the Access-Control-Allow-Origin header as shown in figure 3.20.

Note that although a resource has an `Access-Control-Allow-Origin: *` header, it doesn't necessarily mean that it's publicly accessible. There may be additional forms of authentication on the resource, as you'll see in chapter 6.

The wildcard is just one way to respond to CORS requests. Now let's look at using actual origin values in the Access-Control-Allow-Origin header.